PromptToInvoice — Project Estimate & Delivery Plan

Oct 29, 2026

Overview

PromptToInvoice v1 can be delivered in **3–4 weeks** by one dedicated full-stack developer, rebuilt on a clean, production-ready foundation.

The current codebase has the right idea but is not stable enough to build on: core pages are incomplete, business logic sits in a few very large components, and there is no PDF output, email delivery, subscription billing or automated testing. Rather than patch it, v1 will be rebuilt from scratch. The existing landing page and invoice designs will be reused as visual reference so no design work is lost.

v1 delivers the core promise of the product: a user describes their work in plain language and gets a correct, professional invoice they can download or email to their client.

Scope of v1

v1 covers everything needed for the **Starter (free)** and **Professional ($15/month)** plans. Business and Enterprise plan features follow in later phases.

Area	Included in v1
Accounts	Sign up, log in, Google sign-in, email verification, password reset
Business profile	Company name, logo, address, tax / VAT ID, default currency and payment terms
Clients	Client list with contact and tax details, reused across invoices
AI invoice generation	Describe work in plain language; AI drafts client, line items, rates, due date and currency; user reviews and edits before saving
Invoice editor	Manual create and edit, line items, discounts, tax, notes, automatic invoice numbering
Taxes and currency	USD and EUR; percentage tax per invoice (US sales tax, EU VAT, VAT reverse-charge note)
Accurate totals	All totals and taxes calculated by the system, never by the AI

Area	Included in v1
Invoice status	Draft, Sent, Paid, Overdue; mark as paid manually
PDF	Branded, professional PDF download
Email	Send the invoice to the client by email with the PDF attached
Dashboard	Total invoiced, paid, outstanding and overdue; recent invoices
Subscriptions	Stripe checkout for Professional plan, free plan limit of 5 invoices/month, upgrade and cancel
Launch	Landing page with pricing, privacy policy and terms pages, production deployment

Not in v1 (planned for later phases): team seats, multiple business profiles per account, online card payment of invoices by clients, recurring invoices, automatic payment reminders, advanced reports, multiple interface languages, EU structured e-invoicing formats, public API and accounting integrations.

Technology stack options

Both options use **PostgreSQL** and a **Next.js** frontend and deliver the same v1 scope in the same 3–4 weeks; they differ only in the backend framework. PostgreSQL replaces the current MongoDB because invoices, clients and payments are relational financial records that benefit from strict structure and transactions.

	Option A: Express + PostgreSQL + Next.js	Option B: Laravel + PostgreSQL + Next.js
Backend	Node.js, Express, TypeScript	PHP 8, Laravel 12
Database access	Prisma ORM with migrations	Eloquent ORM with migrations
Frontend	Next.js, React, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS	Next.js, React, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS
Authentication	JWT with secure cookies, Google sign-in via Passport	Laravel Sanctum, Google sign-in via Socialite
Subscriptions	Stripe SDK and webhooks	Laravel Cashier (Stripe)
PDF	Server-side PDF from HTML templates	Server-side PDF from Blade templates

	Option A: Express + PostgreSQL + Next.js	Option B: Laravel + PostgreSQL + Next.js
Email and queues	Resend / Postmark, BullMQ with Redis	Laravel Mail and Queues
AI	LLM API with structured JSON output	LLM API with structured JSON output
Language	One language (TypeScript) across frontend and backend	Two languages (PHP backend, TypeScript frontend)
Built-in features	Lightweight; more pieces assembled by hand	Batteries included: auth, queues, mail, billing, admin tooling
Hosting	Vercel (frontend) + Railway / Render / AWS (API and database)	Vercel (frontend) + Laravel Forge / Cloud, or any VPS
Hiring pool	Large JavaScript / TypeScript talent pool	Large PHP / Laravel talent pool

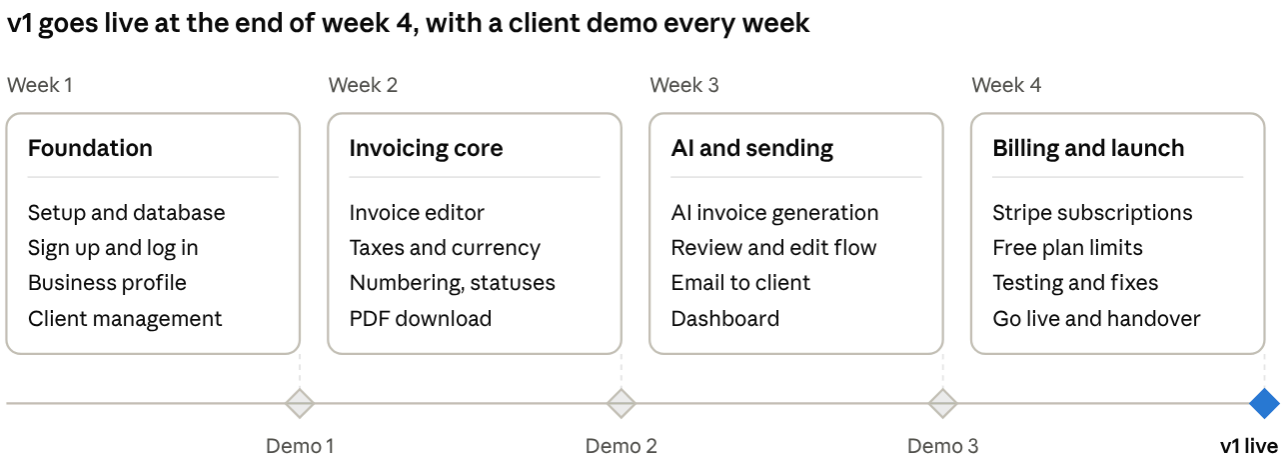
Option A suits a team that wants a single language end to end and plans to hire JavaScript developers. It also reuses the current Node.js setup, so the existing environment and accounts carry over.

Option B suits a team that values Laravel's built-in tooling. Subscriptions (Cashier), queues and mail come ready-made, which lowers long-term maintenance for billing logic.

Either option is a sound choice; the decision mainly depends on which language the client's future team will maintain.

Milestones and timeline

v1 is delivered in four weekly milestones, each ending with a working demo on a staging site the client can test.



v1 delivery plan · 4 weekly milestones

Week 4 includes the buffer for review feedback and launch checks. If reviews are quick and client inputs arrive in week 1, launch can move forward to the end of week 3.

Effort estimate

v1 is estimated at **about 140 hours** (range 130–160) of development, which is the same for either stack option.

Work package	Hours
Project setup, architecture, database design, authentication	20
Invoice editor, taxes, currency, numbering, statuses	24
AI invoice generation and review flow	20
PDF generation and email sending	16
Stripe subscriptions and plan limits	14
Testing, bug fixing, handover	14
Business profile and client management	12
Dashboard	10
Landing page, legal pages, production deployment	10
Total	**140**

The range covers normal variation in review feedback and third-party setup. Changes to scope after kickoff are estimated separately.

Pricing

v1 is offered at a **fixed price of $1,500 (USD)**, covering the full scope above, either stack option, and deployment to production.

Payment	Due	Amount (USD)
30%	At kickoff	$450
40%	After Demo 2 (end of week 2)	$600
30%	At go-live and handover	$450
Total		**$1,500**

The fixed price excludes third-party service costs (hosting, AI usage, email, Stripe fees), which are billed directly to the client's accounts. Changes to scope after kickoff are quoted separately before work begins.

Assumptions and client inputs

The 3–4 week timeline assumes the scope above stays fixed and the inputs below arrive in the first week.

Assumptions

- One dedicated full-stack developer; the client reviews each weekly demo within 2 business days.
- UI follows the existing landing page and invoice designs; no separate design phase.
- No data needs to be migrated from the current system.
- Tax handling is a percentage rate chosen per invoice; automatic tax-rate lookup by location is not included.
- Third-party service costs (hosting, AI usage, email, Stripe fees) are paid by the client.

Needed from the client

- [ ] Choice of stack: Option A or Option B
- [ ] Brand assets: logo, colours, product domain name
- [ ] Accounts with admin access: Stripe, AI provider, email provider, hosting, Google (for sign-in)
- [ ] Final pricing and plan limits confirmed
- [ ] Privacy policy and terms of service text (or approval to use a standard template)
- [ ] One sample invoice the client considers "ideal", used as the PDF reference

Future phases

After v1 launches, the Business and Enterprise plans can be built in two further phases, each estimated and agreed separately.

Phase	Unlocks	Main features	Estimate	Price (USD)
Phase 2	Business plan ($39)	Team seats and roles, multiple business profiles, online card payment of invoices, recurring invoices, automatic payment reminders, advanced reports and CSV export	2–3 weeks	$800–1,000
Phase 3	Enterprise plan	Public API with API keys and webhooks, QuickBooks / Xero integration, single sign-on, audit logs	3–4 weeks	$1,000–1,300
Add-on	EU readiness	Structured e-invoice formats (Factur-X / ZUGFeRD, XRechnung, Peppol), which France and Germany are phasing in as mandatory for business-to-business invoices from 2027	1–2 weeks	$400–600
Add-on	Localisation	Interface and invoices in additional languages (e.g. German, French, Spanish)	1 week	$200–300

Future phase prices are indicative ranges; each phase is confirmed as a fixed price once its scope is agreed.

Next steps

1. Client confirms the v1 scope and chooses Option A or Option B.
2. Agree the final timeline and start date.
3. Client shares the inputs listed above; development starts with Week 1.